

Abilities

	active	static	dynamic
<i>matter</i>	strength force thrust carrying	endurance courage resolve stamina	agility speed precision manipulation
<i>mind</i>	charisma luck drive conviction	aura power resilience persistence	thought wit flexibility processing

Generate

d100	score	
1–30	0	unremarkable
31–55	1	promising
56–75	2	talented
76–90	3	gifted
91–99	4	excellent
100	5	incredible
<0		underhuman
5<		overhuman

→ Abilities p12–13

Traits

7 + thought trait slots

#	tier	roll	bonus
I	skilled	+3	make a living
II	expert	+6	teach the trait
III	master	+9	a rare genius

3 traits at level 1, +1 per level

→ background traits p15

→ path traits p16–17 (+ p114–159)

→ free traits p18

Items

7 + strength item slots

size	example
1 sack (sk)	kit of starting gear p23
10 stones (st)	significant item p22
100 soaps (sp)	small item
2500 cash (€)	laborer's day wage coin

→ lots of items p64–85

Burdens

Twenty special inventory slots for afflictions, traits, and items that are so difficult to bear that they impose penalties to your actions. **Each burden imposes a -1 to all rolls.**

→ burdens p28, p59

Save

d20 + ability vs 13

under 13 → **Doom**. What was, will be.exactly 13 → **Sacrifice**. Lose a precious thing to save.over 13 → **Save**. Disaster averted, fortune appeased.

→ save p25

Referees give **bonus** and **penalties**.

[+]/[-]	effect	%
+/-1	tiny modifier, barely noticeable	5%
+/-6	significant modifier, very noticeable	30%
+/-1d6	random modifier, muddy odds	17.5%
[+a]/[-d]	Roll 2 dice and take better/worse result. Increases probability of extreme natural rolls, roll range stays unchanged.	16.6%

Hard limit option: mods cannot exceed +/-13. Excession: referee rules autosuccess (autofail) or limits mod to +/-13 and grants [+a] or [-d].

→ bonuses and penalties p40

Humans

	d100	level	life	hero dice	xp	morale	defense	bonus	damage
									<i>NPCs only</i>
	01–20	0	4	0d6	0	2	7	+3	1d4
<i>start</i>	20–39	1	8	1d6	300	3	8	+4	1d6+1
	40–59	2	12	2d6	750	4	9	+5	1d8+2
	60–74	3	16	3d6	1,500	5	10	+6	1d10+3
	75–84	4	20	4d6	3,000	6	11	+8	1d12+5
	85–92	5	24	5d6	6,000	7	12	+10	2d8+6
	93–97	6	28	6d6	12,500	8	13	+12	2d10+9
	98	7	32	7d6	25,000	9	14	+14	2d12+12
	99	8	36	8d6	50,000	10	15	+16	3d10+15
	00	9	40	9d6	99,999	11	16	+18	4d12+20

→ levels, life, HD p24–25 → xp p30–31

Defend and Attack

defense	attack	damage
7 + ability (agility)	d20	dX (item)
+ bonus (if skill applies) + armor	+ ability (per type) + skill over defense	+ ability (per trait) + bonus (circumstantial)
melee (str) / ranged (agi) / oldtech (tho) / fantascience (cha)		

→ conflicts p26–27 → in detail p46–63

Rolling

Roll d20 + ability (if applicable) + skill (if applicable) **over** TN.

typical target numbers

3	trivial, casual, banal (excellent odds)
7	easy, simple, routine
11	mediocre, moderate, average, medium, [null]
15	hard, challenging, tasking
19	very hard, confounding, arduous (terrible odds)

→ the roll p39

Magic numbers on natural d20 rolls:

1 → **fail**, and equipment notched. Mark the item. More damage = it breaks.

13 → **one** ammo or other resource **left**. Mark the item. After the next use, it is spent.

20 → always **succeeds**. Double effect or additional stunt (trip, trick, trap), then roll again (d20 explodes).

→ nuances p40

Exploding dice (dX*). Roll the highest face → roll again and add the results. Roll as long as the die shows highest face. D20s always explode, even without an asterisk.

→ dX* p40

Group roll. When a group is trying to accomplish something risky, a random PC rolls for the whole group.

→ group roll p41

Roll precisely **on target** → PCs can **sacrifice** to succeed. Sacrifice: resources, damage, life, burden, alert, benefits, innocents, risk.

→ on target p41

quick d6 oracle

1–3	expected (50% odds)
4–5	unusual (33% odds)
6	exceptional (17% odds)

→ dice oracles p42

Relative Zones and Range

The referee adjudicates relative zones and ranges based on the the location and participants of the conflict. For vehicle scale comparison see p52.

zone	range	on foot (human scale)
here	close	Adjacent. Melee combat. The thick of things. A small area, a few meters across. This side of the table, in arm's reach. You may make a free attack against an adjacent enemy that disengages carelessly.
there	short	Nearby. The other side of the table, out of reach. A middling area, maybe 10m across. You can close for melee combat with a nearby opponent. Or, you can retreat further away, keeping them at range while firing.
over there	medium	Far. Indoors, through a doorway or at the far end of a hall. A large area, maybe a few dozen meters across. Usually, you need 2 rounds to close with an opponent this far away. The first round to reduce the range to short range, the second to charge in for close combat.
off-stage	long	Distant. Very far. Indoors, a few rooms away, downstairs, or behind a closed door. Not visible. A massive area, possibly 100m across. At this range you need 3+ rounds to close with an opponent. Reaching them is more a chase than a conflict (see p57).

NPC Reaction

random PC rolls 2d6 + cha

≤1	Immediately violent.
2	Hostile, keen to attack.
3-5	Cold, hateful.
6-8	Unsure, waffling, suspicious.
9-11	Polite, understanding.
12	Friendly, keen to help.
13≤	Helpful whether needed or not; keen to waste your time.

→ *reaction p47*

Approaches to Challenges

The referee judges whether and how abilities and traits apply using common sense and shared fiction.

impossible → **no roll**

pure luck → **roll bare d20**

natural ability alone → **d20 + ability**

skill & ability → **d20 + ability + skill**

sure thing → **no roll**

→ *abilities & traits p43-45*

d20 + modifier oracle

≤3	nay and woe!
4-7	nay
8-13	perhaps, for a price
14-19	yea
20≤	yea and more!

→ *dice oracles p42*

Initiative

→ *movement and range p52-55*

Every round, a random character from each side rolls **2d6 + agility**.

High roll goes first.

When initiative rolls are tied, everything happens at once. All characters take their turns, then damage and afflictions take effect at the end of the round.

→ *rounds p47*

Morale

typical NPC morale = 3 + 1/2 level

2	craven cowards, rabbits and broken rabble
3-5	sheep, civilians, levies
6-8	militias, professionals, elites
9-10	rare zealots, terrifying golems
11	possessed, fearless, or doomed
Ø	mere machines, things without self-preservation, shells driven by extra-cosmic daemons have no morale scores and cannot test morale

A random character rolls 2d6 to test morale for the whole group.

over	NPCs break: flees, retreats, surrenders, ends combat. Better trained = steadier.
equal	NPCs redouble efforts: bonus on their next action.
under	NPCs continue to struggle, grimly determined, resolute for now.

→ *morale p56*

Pursuit

Only pursuers roll—if they don't make an effort, the prey gets away. A random character in the group makes a group chase roll, adding endurance and any relevant skill bonuses.

d20 + end + relevant skill

1-3	Chase fails after 2d6 rounds. Save or (d6): (1) led astray, (2-3) lost, (4) lose 1 end, (5) lose 1d6 life, (6) get very dirty.
4-7	Chase fails after 1d6+1 rounds.
8-11	Lose 1d4+1 rounds. Reroll with disadv. to keep chasing.
12-14	Lose 1d4+1 rounds. Reroll with adv. to keep chasing.
15-19	Catch prey after 1d6+1 rounds. Roll initiative.
20-24	Catch prey after 1d4 rounds. Win initiative.
25+	Surprise prey after 1d4 rounds. No initiative first round.

→ *chase and escape p57*

Turn

Each round, each character gets a turn when their side acts. On their turn they **do something**.

→ *rounds p47*

Action

A character can attempt nearly anything the player imagines. The referee adjudicates if it requires die rolls and whether bonuses or penalties are called for.

Most turns, a PC performs a reasonable combination of **movement and interaction**.

→ *action examples p48-49*

Defeat

Roll if an effect would reduce a character below 0 life or ability.

2d6 + end for physical damage, **2d6 + aur** for mental damage, plain **2d6** for overwhelming dmg.

≤1	Destroyed. Character gone for at least the rest of this session
2-6	Dead. Relife intervention required.
7	Knocked out. -1 thought burden.
8	Winded. -1 strength burden. Lose next turn, then regain 1 life.
9	Strained. -1 agility burden. Lose next turn, then regain 1 life.
10	Scarred. -1 charisma burden. Lose next turn, then regain 1 life.
11	Stunned. Lose next turn, then regain 1 life.
12+	All ok! Immediately regain 1 life.

→ *defeat p60*

Rest

Each week, remove one affliction:

- ✧ Regain all missing life.
- ✧ Restore one missing ability score.
- ✧ Remove one burden.

Faster recovery may be available:

Cheap restoratives (€2d6) include healing unguents (restore 1d6 life) and restorative tonics (restore 1 ability or remove 1 burden).

Pricey restoratives (€2d6 x 10) incl. medical packs (restore 2d6 life or 1d3 ability points) and repair parasites (regrow limbs, heal illnesses, or remove complex burdens)

→ *rest p62*

Running Out

Resources have three states:

- ✧ **enough:** keep using your gear.
- ✧ **running low:** one use left.
- ✧ **run out:** take action to reload, refuel, or otherwise replenish.

Running low: roll a natural 13 → only one use remaining.

Run out: roll the replenish score or less (e.g. re 5) → resources run out.

→ *resources p66–67*

Gadgets

d54	item	size	cost
1	Grappling Hook	2 st	€5
2	Smart Rope	1 st	€10
3	Climbing Gear	2 st	€20
4	Inflatable Raft	1 st	€50
5	Aerolith Anchor	2 st	€75
6	Exoskelegolem	5 st	€500
7	Chronometer	1 sp	€25
8	Electronic Ear	5 sp	€25
9	Clicker Casket	5 sp	€50
10	Microgolem	1 st	€50
11	Holomap	1 st	€100
12	Bioscanner	1 st	€200
13	Dampsound Shoes	1 st	€20
14	Unnoticeability Mask	1 st	€25
15	Voice Modulator	5 sp	€30
16	Wall-Blender	1 st	€50
17	Dark-Vision Goggles	1 st	€90
18	Soft-Hands Gloves	1 st	€110
19	Disintegrality Spray	1 st	€15
20	Mechatronic Picks	1 st	€25
21	Multi-Auto Tool	2 st	€50
22	Interface Gauntlet	1 st	€100
23	Augmented Reality	1 st	€105
24	Omni-Utilitool	1 st	€200
25	Nasal Filters	1 sp	€5
26	Emergency Flare	1 st	€10
27	Glo Paint	1 st	€15
28	Hyper Adhesive	1 st	€30

Relife

Death is not the end. All it takes is €1d6 x 100 plus a soul licensing fee. Bring your body to a casket swiftly.

roll d20 + endurance

1–5	Damage reduces your thought and charisma by 1 each.
6–10	Your body requires vital bodily fluids (€1d6 x 10) weekly or it decays, losing 1 ability point.
11–15	Your face is marked by the death you have lived.
16–19	You seem untouched.
20+	Your fear of not being is lessened. Gain +1 ward.

→ *relife p63*

Single-Use Replenishers

d6	item	size	cost
1	Dehydrated Water (for 1 human)	1 sp	€20
2	Fillgut (1 human)	1 sp	€5
3	Microbattery (for a 1 st item)	1 sp	€7
4	Nanoammo (any weapon)	1 sp	€100
5	Omnibattery (any item)	1 st	€50
6	Power Cube (any machine)	1 st	€25

→ *replenishing p67*

d54	item	size	cost
29	Enviro Mask	1 st	€50
30	Rebreather	2 st	€150
31	Invisibilly Bomb	1 st	€25
32	Signal Jammer	1 st	€50
33	Portable EM Pulser	1 st	€50
34	Nanopear Spray	1 st	€100
35	Aug-Harness	1 st	€200
36	Nulla Charger	1 st	€450
37	Alarwurm Box	5 sp	€10
38	Distraction Projector	1 st	€100
39	Ear Jewels	1 st	€100
40	Ear Slug	1 sp	€100
41	Control Choke	1 st	€200
42	Credenticard	1 sp	€200
43	Water Pills	1 sp	€5
44	Void Thermos	1 st	€25
45	Oculars	1 st	€50
46	Astral Compass	2 sp	€50
47	Ray Banas	1 sp	€100
48	Solar Lamp	5 sp	€100
49	Folding Chair	1 st	€5
50	Musical Instrument	1 st	€10
51	Campaign Bed	2 st	€35
52	Enviro Tent	1 st	€50
53	Portable Illusion	1 st	€250
54	Radiothermal Stove	1 st	€1k

→ *gadgets p82–83*

Interpret and Use

Assume **natural language**.

Equipment does what it says. It unlocks new abilities or improves existing ones. Use common sense and referee judgment.

Five standard item mechanics:

- ✧ Each ready item occupies at least 1 stone of inventory.
- ✧ Many items can serve as improvised weapons.
- ✧ On a natural roll of 1, notched equipment. Notched equipment breaks on a natural 1.
- ✧ Under pressure, lack of suitable equipment imposes a penalty, while the perfect equipment for a job provides a bonus.
- ✧ If a roll misses by 1, sacrifice equipment (damage, deplete) to succeed.

→ *equipment p65*

Consumables

d36	item	size	cost
1	Green Ortholentils	1 sp	€1
2	Purple Worm Sausages	1 sp	€3
3	Blue Spacecake	1 sp	€5
4	Red Nutrilurry	2 sp	€5
5	Yellowbrain C-Crème	1 sp	€20
6	Orange Ratgum	1 sp	€60
7	Cat Coffee	1 sp	€2
8	You Go	1 sp	€3
9	Keep It Up Cha	1 sp	€5
10	Synthetic Blood	1 st	€20
11	Photosynth Sap	1 st	€50
12	Soul Juice	1 st	€300
13	Curative Snake Oil	1 sp	€10
14	Violet City Healotion	1 sp	€40
15	Flesh Soil	1 st	€50
16	Healmachine	1 st	€60
17	Ultra-Purga	1 st	€200
18	Full-Heal Kit	1 st	€300
19	Felix Whizz	1 sp	€1
20	Purple Haze	0.1sp	€2
21	Black Light Lotus	1 sp	€5
22	Lemma Worm	1 st	€10
23	Whiskers	1 st	€15
24	Glitchvidy	1 st	€50
25	UV Lotion	1 sp	€5
26	Philip Juice	1 sp	€10
27	Octarine Oil	1 sp	€20
28	Otherface Cream	1 sp	€45
29	Eggplant Elixir	1 sp	€50
30	Tonic Harmony	1 sp	€75
31	Goat Bricks	1 sk	€5
32	Voyager Supplies	1 sk	€10
33	Injectable Fodder	2 st	€20
34	Std. Corposolene	1 sk	€20
35	Void Paste	2 st	€50
36	Song-Ghost Fuel	2 st	€100

→ *consumables p84–85*

Weapons

	small	medium	large	very large
size	<1 st	1 st	2 st	3+ st
damage	1d3 or 1d4	1d6 or 1d8	1d10 or 1d12	2d8 or more
feature	concealed	one-handed	two-handed	mounted
melee	dagger	sword	polearm	divine rod
ranged	pistol	blaster	projector	autocannon

Human Scale Ranges

	close	short	medium	long
meters	<2m	1–10m	5–50m	40m+
words	here	there	over there	way off over there
combat	melee	pistol, blaster	rod, projector	mortar, cannon

Area Effects

	single	small	medium	large
circle	<1m across	1–4m across	4–16m across	16–64m across
cone	15° wide and <2m long	30° wide and 4m long	60° wide and 8m long	90° wide and 16m long
line	2m	8m	32m	128m
# targets	one	a few (~1d4-1)	some (~2d6-2)	many (~2d12-2)

→ weapons p68–73

Armors

	small	light	medium	heavy	golem
size	<1 st	1 st	2 st	3 st	4+ st
armors	bracers	shield, linen	amber, chitin	porcelain, chain	automato
bonus	1–2	1–3	2–6	3–9	4–12

→ armors p74–77

Wards

	trinket	wearable	portable	bulky
size	<1 st	1 st	1–2 st	3+ st
wards	scarab	circlet	pectoral	homunculo
bonus	1–5	1–5	2–7	3–9

→ wards p78–79

Rides

	velocipede	conveyance	familiar van	golem bus	road train
level	0–1	1–4	2–7	4–9	7–13
size	skeleton-sized	cow-sized	greater unicorn-sized	indricothere-sized	whale-sized
capacity	1–2 sk	2–6 sk	4–12 sk	6–24 sk	12–48 sk
speed	normal	slow	normal / fast	slow / normal	v. slow / slow
power	pedal	pull or push	fuel or golem	coalem/golem	atom/pneuma
supply	-	-	1 / wk	2 / wk	3 / wk

→ rides p86–93

Corruption Exposure

When you are exposed to corruption, you:

1. Immediately **gain a burden** (such as a dramatic nosebleed or headache).
2. **Roll 2d6 + aura** to figure out your corruption exposure severity.
3. Roll on the **corruption table** (p99) and acquire a commensurate new **corruption trait**. Corruption traits can occupy a trait or item slot. Some would call these traits mere mutations, underplaying how offensive they are to the Lords of the Dream and the MKR of the Cosmos.

2d6+aur corruption exposure severity

≤2	Unexpected amplification. Head explodes, but the corruption keeps you alive until you starve. Also, severe corruption exposure (below).
3–6	Severe exposure. Violently ill. Lose 1d6 ability points. And more ...
7–10	Moderate exposure. Terrible visions. Lose 1d6 life. And more ...
11–12	Mild exposure. You feel fine. Possibly euphoric. And more ...
13+	Mild exposure (above) and regain the price of the power.

→ corruption p98–100

Store and Activate

Credulous post-technologicals call them spells and magicks.

You can use a power stored in any inventory (trait, item, burden).

Pay **life equal to its power level** to activate a power.

Overcharge doubles the power level to deliver a modified effect.

→ powers p96

Example Power Levels

Assigning power levels is more art than science.

P such as

0 ... requires no life sacrifice. It is weaker than an ordinary action, like running or firing a pistol, but allows some specialized or unusual effect.

1 ... is a little more valuable and powerful than the mundane equipment of this modern day.

7 ... has a potent effect that changes the fundamental rules of a local reality in interesting ways.

13 ... is a terrible technique that may disable enemies or make semi-permanent changes to base reality.

21 ... is the stuff of fairytales; decades of slumber, exploding mountains, small iron stars falling from the sky, and other drastic reality changes.

42 ... may corrupt any mortal, rewriting histories and transforming eons.

99 ... was used but once by the mightiest half-divine magus who gave their life in the process.

→ power levels p97

Dangerous Powers

Any power may be dangerous if:

- ✧ you have no suitable skill;
- ✧ or, your level is lower than the power's price;
- ✧ or, it has the dangerous attribute.

When you use a dangerous power, make a **danger roll**:

d20

+ **ability** (usually aura)
+ **skill** (if relevant)
over the price of the power.

The referee can apply additional modifiers. A natural 1 always fails.

If you fail the danger roll you are **exposed to corruption** (left).

→ dangerous powers p97